Jon Wick

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Summary

I am an undergraduate researcher and avid outdoorsman at Western Washington University. I am interested in building a community in the Bellingham area. During my time as a researcher at WWU I gained time-management, perseverance, and communication skills. As Housing Ambassador and Molecular Biosciences club lead I interacted with a variety of students and families, assisting them in making an informed decision about the university, major selection, research, and planning for their future.

Education

B.S. Molecular and Cellular Biology, Computer Science minor — September 2023-present
Western Washington University – Bellingham, WA — Expected June 2026
- **GPA**: 3.53/4.0

Tacoma Community College – Concurrent Enrollment — September 2021-June 2023

Experience

Undergraduate Researcher, Lee Lab, WWU – Bellingham, WA — June 2024 - present
- Investigate roles of sRNAs in an RNAi pathway responsible for maintaining genome integrity in *Tetrahymena thermophila* using computational biology and genomic sequence analysis.
- Develop new tools and apply existing tools using R, Python, Bash, C, and C++.
- Prepared presentations for round tables, lab meetings, and journal clubs.
- Participated full-time in the WWU Biology Summer Undergraduate Research Program (SURP).
- Performed Western Blots, maintained *Tetrahymena* cells, and performed literature reviews to progress the goals of the lab.

Club Lead, Molecular Bioscience Club, WWU – Bellingham, WA — August 2025 - present
- Organize events to build community and provide information about programs, research oportunites, and professional development to students of all course standings.
- Assisted students in getting into research labs.
- Collaborated with faculty within and outside of WWU on events.

Housing Ambassador, WWU – Bellingham, WA — September 2023 - June 2024
- Developed an inclusive environment for students to learn about housing at WWU.
- Collaborated with fellow ambassador's
- Collaborated with faculty within and outside of WWU on events.

Computing Education Research, Sushil K. Oswal, UW – Tacoma, WA — February 2023 - May 2024
- Wrote and published a paper for the *ACM Special Interest Group Computer Science Education* conference about education and mentorship structure in an extracurricular robotics team.
- Performed a qualitative analysis on interviews and survey responses to extract useful data.
- Formulated research questions for interviews and surveys.

Biotech Research Intern, Rain Incubator – Tacoma, WA — May 2022 - December 2022
- Collaborated with researchers to define novel methods for tracking European Green Crab migration in Puget Sound.
- Learned the research process of defining a hypothesis, performed literature review, and planned experiments.
- Performed pilot experiments using PCR to define future directions.

Programming Lead, SOTAbots FIRST Team 2557 – Tacoma, WA — September 2019 - June 2023
- Developed Code used in the semi-finals of the 2022 World Championship of FIRST Robotics Competition and 2023 district championship.
- Taught students to program in Java using industry-standard design patterns.
- Coordinated with other leads on the team to develop a robot, build community, perform local outreach, and obtain funding.